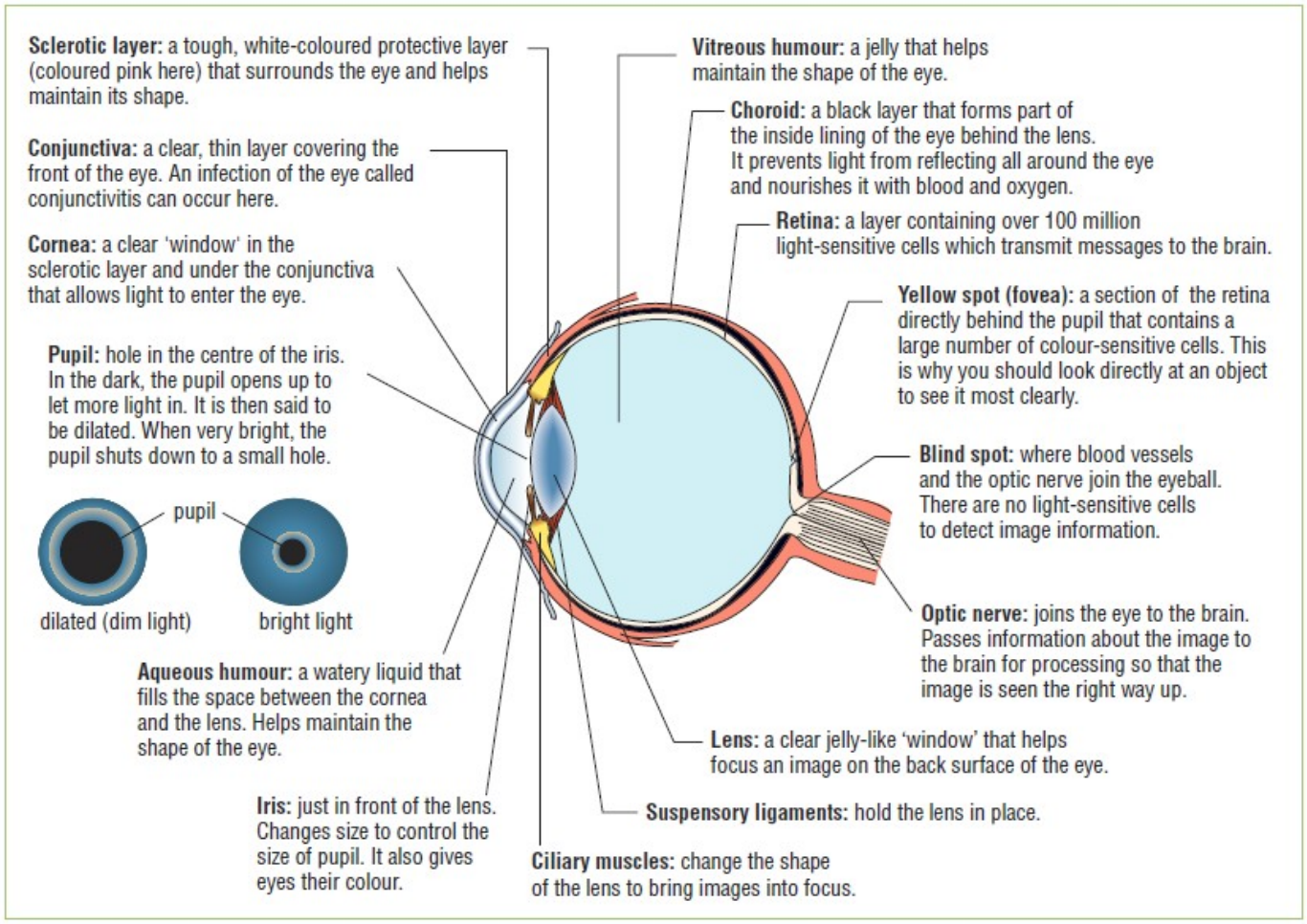


Sclerotic layer: a tough, white-coloured protective layer (coloured pink here) that surrounds the eye and helps maintain its shape.
Conjunctiva: a clear, thin layer covering the front of the eye. An infection of the eye called conjunctivitis can occur here.
Cornea: a clear 'window' in the sclerotic layer and under the conjunctiva that allows light to enter the eye.
Pupil: hole in the centre of the iris. In the dark, the pupil opens up to let more light in. It is then said to be dilated. When very bright, the pupil shuts down to a small hole.
pupil
dilated (dim light)
bright light
Aqueous humour: a watery liquid that fills the space between the cornea and the lens. Helps maintain the shape of the eye.
Iris: just in front of the lens. Changes size to control the size of pupil. It also gives eyes their colour.
Ciliary muscles: change the shape of the lens to bring images into focus.
Suspensory ligaments: hold the lens in place.
Lens: a clear jelly-like 'window' that helps focus an image on the back surface of the eye.
Optic nerve: joins the eye to the brain. Passes information about the image to the brain for processing so that the image is seen the right way up.
Blind spot: where blood vessels and the optic nerve join the eyeball. There are no light-sensitive cells to detect image information.
Yellow spot (fovea): a section of the retina directly behind the pupil that contains a large number of colour-sensitive cells. This is why you should look directly at an object to see it most clearly.
Retina: a layer containing over 100 million light-sensitive cells which transmit messages to the brain.
Choroid: a black layer that forms part of the inside lining of the eye behind the lens. It prevents light from reflecting all around the eye and nourishes it with blood and oxygen.
Vitreous humour: a jelly that helps maintain the shape of the eye.